SmartBridge Educational Services Pvt. Ltd.

Leave Policy

Leave Policy

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Revision

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1. Objective

The primary objective of introducing Leave policy is to ensure employees are provided with a reasonable and regular amount of rest and recreation away from work. Some types of leaves are introduced for personal emergencies. This policy is a guideline for all employees to follow and explains the types of leaves available, the eligibility and the procedure to avail leaves.

2. Scope and Applicability

It will be applicable to all full-time permanent employees in the organization.

3. Definition/Glossary

Term / Abbreviation	Definition / Expansion	No. of Leaves
EL	Earned Leave	8 days
CL	Casual Leave	8 days
SL	Sick Leave	8 days
ML	Maternity Leave	90 days
PTL	Paternity Leave	3 days
BL	Bereavement Leave	3 days

4. Policy/Process

4.1. Owner & Administration

HR owns the leave policy and hence will administer the same appropriately. The policies and procedures are subject to change from time to time depending on various socio-economic factors or as per law and will be decided solely by the CEO of the organization.

4.2. Eligibility

All regular and confirmed employees of the organization are covered in the leave policy. Employees who are on probation will be eligible for all types of leaves. Leave year begins from 1st of January to 31st of December each year. Leaves will be credited to individual employee's leave account on the 1st Jan for the entire year but employees can't avail of leaves in advance during the year. Employees who have joined during the year will be eligible for prorated leaves from the date of joining.

Any weekly offs or declared holidays or national holidays which fall in between any leaves applied by an employee will not be considered as leave days.

4.3. Types of Leaves

4.3.1. Earned Leave

All employees are eligible for 8 days of EL per annum. This policy applies to all regular full-time employees. Earned leave will be granted based on the availability of leave credits and operational requirements. The Earned Leave policy is designed to provide employees with a reasonable amount of time off for rest, relaxation, and personal commitments while ensuring the smooth functioning.

- **Carry Forward to next leave cycle**: **Maximum of 4** unused Earned Leave (EL) from the current leave cycle will be carried forward to the next year and added to the quota for the subsequent leave cycle.

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Procedure to avail EL: Employees are required to submit leave requests at least 7 days in advance, except in cases of emergencies or unforeseen circumstances. EL has to be regularized through Zoho portal & Official mail at the earliest opportunity by the employee, which otherwise might lead to loss of pay.

4.3.2. Casual Leave

- All confirmed employees are eligible for 8 days of CL per completed year of service. However, employees can't avail leave during the year in advance.
- No additional monetary/non-monetary compensation will be given to the employee in lieu of any lapsed CL.
- Grant of leaves is at the discretion of the Manager or HR, as the case may be, and in line with the ground reality of any important assignments or client commitment that cannot be compromised.

Procedure to avail CL: Employees are required to plan their Casual leaves at least 4 days before in advance and inform their managers. Post the discussion and agreement, CL should be appropriately applied through official e-mail & Zoho HRMS Portal.

4.3.3. Sick Leave

All employees are eligible for 8 days of SL per annum. SL cannot be availed for more than 3 days at a time. In case of SL availed for more than prescribed days, it should be accompanied by a registered doctor's certificate.

Procedure to avail SL: Employees are urged to keep their managers informed of their sickness at the earliest in order to allow them to plan for continuity of tasks on hand. SL has to be regularized through Zoho portal & Official mail at the earliest opportunity by the employee, which otherwise might lead to loss of pay.

No additional monetary/non-monetary compensation will be given to the employee in lieu of any lapsed SL.

4.3.4. Maternity Leave

Female employees who have worked continuously for a period of 80 days is minimum as per law with the company in the past twelve months immediately preceding the date of expected delivery is eligible for maternity leave as per Maternity Benefits Act, as amended in Mar 2017.

Eligible employees can avail of paid Maternity leave for a continuous period of 6 months, of which 8 weeks can be availed for the pre-natal period. With every subsequent child, the mother can avail 3 months, or 12 weeks, off for her maternity leave, which is a paid leave wherein her employer needs to pay her salary in full.

Maternity leave of 12 weeks for adopting a child below 3 months and for commissioning mothers are allowed.

Any other maternity conditions other than normal pre-natal / post-natal conditions should be based on doctor's certificate and discussed with HR / Manager for sanctioning appropriate number of days leave and as permitted by law

Procedure to avail ML: Employees must keep their managers well informed of their ML to allow them to make alternate plans for continuity of tasks on hand.
Submit a Formal Request: Please send an email to the HR department at hr@thesmartbridge.com at least 6 weeks before (as per Maternity Benefit act, 1961) your expected leave date. Include your expected due date and the duration of leave you intend to take.

Medical Certificate: Attach a medical certificate from your doctor confirming your pregnancy and expected delivery date.

Leave Form: Complete the maternity leave application form, provided by HR and submit the completed form to hr@thesmartbridge.com.

Approval Process: Once employee's request and documents are received, we will process the application and notify the employee of the approval status within 5 days.

4.3.5. Paternity Leave

Male employees are eligible to avail 3 days of PTL from the date of birth of their child.

Procedure to avail PTL: Employees are required to keep their managers well informed of their leave plans to allow them to make alternate plans for continuity of tasks on hand. PTL must be applied Zoho portal & Official mail by the employee.

4.3.6. Bereavement Leave

All employees are eligible for 3 days of BL per annum. It is applicable only in the case of demise of an immediate family which includes Parents, spouse, siblings, kids & in-laws.

Procedure to avail BL: Informing the employer or HR department about the loss is necessary.

4.4. Sandwich Leave Policy

Leaves taken at the beginning of a work week immediately succeeding a weekly off or end of a work week immediately preceding a weekly off will be considered as leave days including the weekly off days. For example, if an employee is taking leave on Saturday and continued his leaves till Monday so the number of his leaves will be 3 including Sunday.

4.5. Other conditions

- Any type of Leave is a subject to prior approval of respective Reporting managers/Leads.
- It is the responsibility of employees to ensure that their respective Managers take appropriate action on the leave applications before proceeding on leaves.

- Leaves availed in an emergency and only under unavoidable circumstances must be regularized in the system as soon as possible, which otherwise will result in loss of pay.

- In the case when an employee becomes ineligible for leaves for whatever reason, leaves availed in excess of eligibility will result in loss of pay (LOP). Also, if an employee takes more than 2 leaves in a month & he/she doesn't have leaves in his/her leave balance then it will be considered as LOP for that particular month or in case of emergency if they need more than 2 leaves in a month, it must be approved by their Reporting manager.

- In adherence to our leave policy, employees are restricted from taking more than 10 consecutive days of leave. Regardless of receiving approval from their reporting managers, any leave exceeding this limit will be considered as Leave Without Pay (LOP) for the respective month.

- Employees are allowed to merge two types of leaves continuously in case of any emergency or urgency.

- Extended SL / ML / PTL must be accompanied by a doctor's certificate and forwarded to HR for action with the consent of the Manager.

- **Important Note**: If an employee takes a leave for a specified period but then continues to be absent without proper approval and fails to report back to the office for the next 30 days, a Warning Letter will be issued to him.

4.6. Compensatory Off

Comp Off is an effort to promote a healthy work-life balance and recognize the hard work and dedication of our employees, we are implementing a compensatory Time Off (Comp Time) policy. This policy is designed to provide flexibility for employees who may need to work beyond their regular hours to meet business demands.

- Scope: This policy applies to all regular, full-time employees of SmartBridge regardless of position or department.
- Utilization of Comp Time: Comp Time must be used within 3 months of accrual.
- Comp Time cannot be converted to cash and will be forfeited upon termination or resignation.

Procedure to avail Comp Off: All requests for Comp Time must be submitted in advance and require approval from the employee's reporting manager. Reporting Managers are responsible for ensuring that Comp Time does not disrupt essential business operations. After that the employee will need to inform HR Department for the comp off adjustments.

5. Special Circumstance and Exception

Maternity Leave is applicable only for female employees.

Paternity Leave is applicable only for male employees.

Any Deviation to this policy has to be approved by the CEO. Any changes to the policy have to be approved by Legal and Compliance.

Conditional Leave Policy

An employee is eligible for additional leaves only under the following conditions:

1. **Medical Grounds** – If an employee is unwell and requires more than **three consecutive sick leaves**, they must submit a valid **doctor's prescription** for approval.
2. **Higher Studies** – Employees pursuing **higher education** are eligible for **5** extra leaves without Loss of pay to appear for **examinations**, subject to prior approval and submission of relevant proof.

All such leave requests will be subject to management approval.

6. Non-compliance and Consequence

Non-compliance or frequent inconsistencies in adherence to this policy will lead to disciplinary action as appropriate by HR and the Manager.